

Hearts Extreme — Playtest Community Guide

Recommended platforms & forums for playtester recruitment

1. BoardGameGeek (BGG)

BGG is ideal for reaching board gamers who already understand trick-taking mechanics. Hearts Extreme's board game roots make this a natural fit.

Forum	Threads / Posts	Purpose	Priority
Seeking Playtesters	3.3K / 13K	Tester recruitment post (Post 1)	★★★ Top
Works in Progress	11K / 168K	Dev diary / updates (Post 2)	★★★ High
Board Game Design	24K / 313K	Mechanic discussion (indirect)	★★ Medium

■ *Note: Seeking Playtesters is primarily for physical board game prototypes. Emphasize that this is a "PC game by a board game designer, based on trick-taking" to feel natural.*

2. Reddit

Reddit offers the largest PC gaming audience. These subreddits are the most relevant for Hearts Extreme:

Subreddit	Subscribers	Purpose	Priority
r/playmygame	~70K	Tester recruitment — most direct match	★★★ Top
r/indiegames	~200K+	Indie game showcase, promo allowed	★★★ High
r/IndieDev	~100K+	Dev diary sharing, community feedback	★★ Medium
r/cardgames	~30K	Card game enthusiast audience	★★ Medium
r/boardgames	~4M	Board gamer crossover audience	★★ Medium
r/SteamDeck	Large	Solo card puzzle = great Deck fit	★ Optional

■ *Note: r/boardgames has strict self-promotion rules. Check subreddit rules before posting.*

3. Discord Servers

Server / Type	How to Find	Purpose
Indie Game Developers	Search Discord server directories	Large indie dev community, testing channels
Playtesting servers	Search "playtest" on Disboard.org	Dedicated playtesting communities
Card Game communities	Search "trick-taking" or "card game"	Niche card game enthusiast groups

4. Other Platforms

Platform	URL	Purpose
Steam Community Hub	store.steampowered.com	Post dev updates on your own game's forum

IndieDB	indiedb.com	Indie game database — dev diary + tester recruitment
itch.io Community	itch.io	Indie game community, devlogs
Twitter/X #IndieGameDev	twitter.com	Hashtag networking with indie devs & players

Recommended Posting Strategy

Target both **board gamers** (who understand trick-taking) and **PC gamers** (who play indie games) simultaneously:

- ① **BGG Seeking Playtesters + Works in Progress** → Board gamer audience
- ② **Reddit r/playmygame** → PC gamer tester recruitment (most effective for Steam games)
- ③ **Reddit r/cardgames + r/indiegames** → Card game & indie game enthusiasts
- ④ **Discord playtesting servers** → Active, engaged testers who give detailed feedback
- ⑤ **Twitter/X #IndieGameDev** → Ongoing visibility & community building